

● AGENTIC AI 2026 · UNICORN GYM · INCUBATOR IDEAS

Rights Reconciliation Agent

It keeps the rights on every published asset honest to what is actually in it.

A registerable agent for the Adobe Agentic framework — and it already runs live inside an assistant.

PROVEN LIVE IN CLAUDE DESKTOP

THE PROBLEM

Rights get inherited. Then the picture changes.

Almost every image a brand publishes is built from other assets — a logo, one or two people, a stock backdrop. Each of those carries its own licensing rights, and every version made from them inherits those rights. That works until the picture changes. When an image is reframed for a phone, a person often gets cropped out of the shot — but their rights stay attached to the file. The asset now claims rights for someone who is no longer in it. Someone has to notice. Today that someone is a person, checking by eye, for every adaptation an AI can produce.

The heart of it

The rights system can only tell you what was inherited. It cannot see that a talent was cropped out. Only looking at the picture can — and that is exactly the judgment we are asking an agent to make.

WHAT WE MEAN BY “RIGHTS”

Every source asset carries a rights profile

Guardian — Rights ↔ Pixels reconciliation

Rights Cloud (Third Party) inherited rights · AI visual check · auto-fix over-inheritance · pre-publish

standalone · vision = mock fixture (server app + API key = live vision)

Lineage sets

Set 14 sources · 3 adapted

SOURCE ASSETS & RIGHTS

Brand Logo

CTR-BRAND-OWNED · global

rights

Talent A — A. Rivera

CTR-TALENT-A · US/CA

rights

Talent B — B. Osei

CTR-TALENT-B · US

rights

Studio backdrop

CTR-BG · global

rights

ADAPTED ASSETS (INHERITED RIGHTS)

Holiday — Mobile 9:16

mobile-9x16 · inherits 4

run

Holiday — Desktop 16:9

desktop-16x9 · inherits 4

run

Holiday — Square 1:1 (partial talent)

square-1x1 · inherits 4

run

Upload an adapted asset

Click to select an adapted asset (PNG).

Sources, rights & presence are derived from its sourceUUID metadata + Rights Cloud — no manual entry.

Source rights profile

As stored in Rights Cloud (Third Party) for this source asset.

Brand Logo

u-brand-logo · Owned IP

SOURCE

Rights type

Owned IP

Licensor

Brand (Owned)

Contract

CTR-BRAND-OWNED

Term

2000-01-01 → 2099-12-31

Territories

global

Channels

web, social, print, email, commerce

Media

digital, print, ooh

Usage

marketing, editorial

Exclusivity

Yes

Usage cap

Unlimited

Restrictions

—

Clearance

Cleared

Brand Logo · u-brand-logo

Audit trail

TIME

ASSET

OUTCOME

INHERITED

REMOVED / FIXED

ESCALATIONS

No runs yet.

Reading a rights profile

For any source — here, the brand's own logo — its rights profile spells out who owns it, the licensor and contract, the dates it is licensed for, the territories and channels it may run in, the media and usage allowed, whether it is exclusive, and any restrictions. This is the promise that must be kept on everything made from it.

On the left, one “lineage set”: four source assets, and three adaptations made from them. Each adaptation inherits all four rights profiles.

WHERE INHERITANCE BREAKS

The rights say four. The picture shows three.

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Talent B — B. OseiCTR-TALENT-B · USrights

Studio backdropCTR-BG · globalrights

ADAPTED ASSETS (INHERITED RIGHTS)

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Holiday — Desktop 16:9desktop-16x9 · inherits 4run

Holiday — Square 1:1 (partial talent)square-1x1 · inherits 4run

Upload an adapted asset

Click to select an adapted asset (PNG). Sources, rights & presence are derived from its sourceUUID metadata + Rights Cloud — no manual entry.

Show full rights profiles (or click a source to expand)

PUBLISHED

Inherited: 4 sources · retained: u-brand-logo, u-talent-a, u-bg · removed: u-talent-b engine: Rights Cloud (Third Party) · vision: mock fixture (stand-in)

BACKDROP

B

TALENT A

ADAPTATION mobile 9:16

Holiday — Mobile 9:16 · mobile-9x16

Inherited per source → visual presence → status

Talent B — B. Osei

u-talent-b · Talent / likeness

cropped out 96%

REMOVED & FIXED

Brand Logo

u-brand-logo · Owned IP

visible 98%

RETAINED

Talent A — A. Rivera

u-talent-a · Talent / likeness

visible 98%

RETAINED

Studio backdrop

u-bg · Stock licence

visible 98%

RETAINED

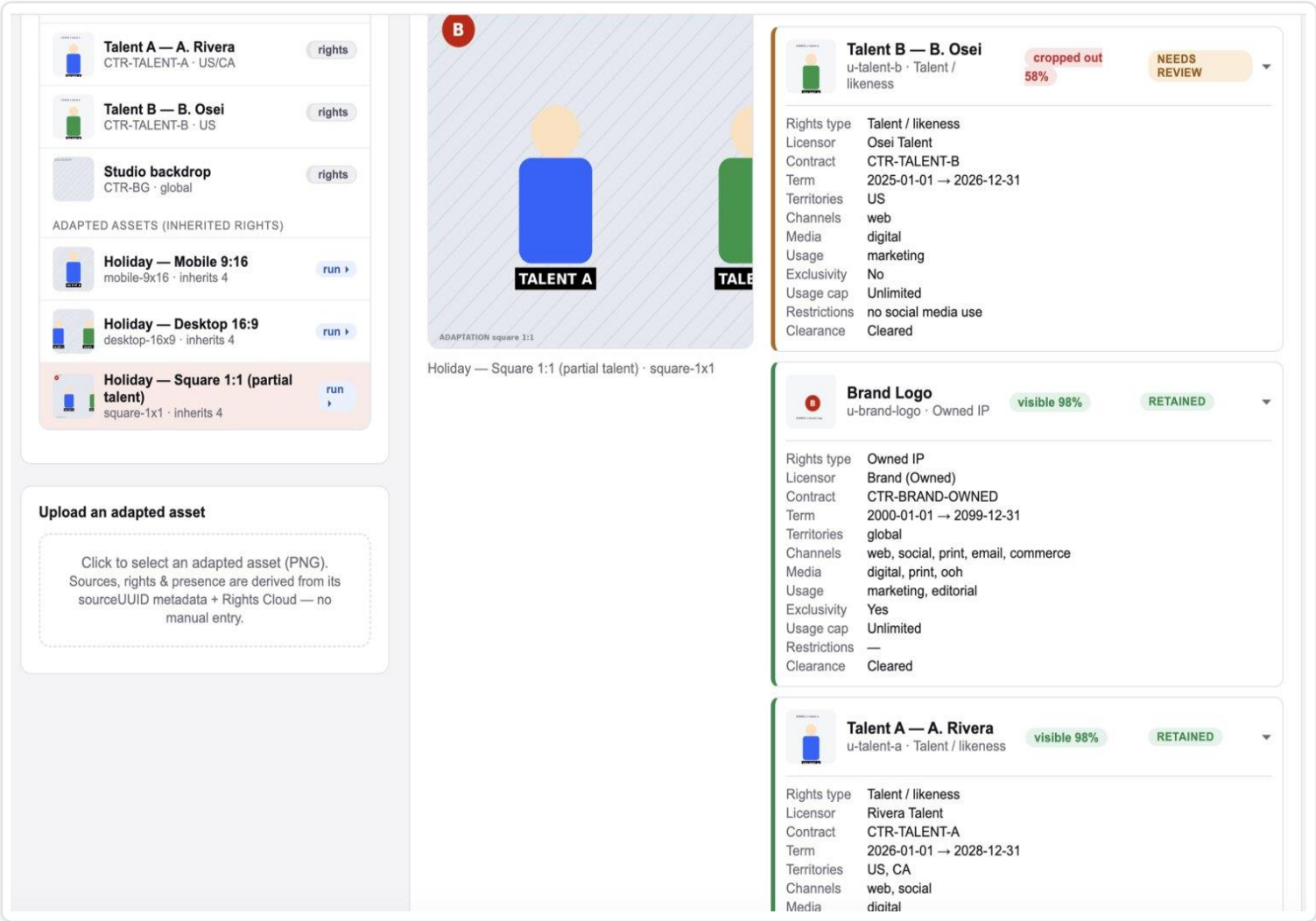
The mobile crop

This adaptation inherited rights from all four sources. But when it was reframed for a 9:16 phone screen, Talent B was cropped out of the shot — you can see only Talent A remains in the frame.

Left unchecked, the file still carries B. Osei's talent rights for a photo she does not appear in — a real cost and a real compliance risk.

WHY A PERSON IS STUCK REVIEWING THIS

Catching it means looking — one asset at a time



A judgment only vision can make

To know Talent B's rights should come off, someone has to open the adaptation, recognise that she is missing, and cross-check her contract — which even carries a “no social media use” restriction. That is careful, expert work.

It is also unrepeatable at scale. When AI turns one campaign into thousands of adaptations, no rights team can eyeball every frame. This is the bottleneck we set out to remove.

THE SOLUTION

An agent that makes that judgment for you

At the moment an adaptation is about to publish, the Rights Reconciliation Agent does what the rights manager would do — automatically.

1

It reads what was inherited

It asks the rights system for the rights that came down onto this adaptation — one profile for each source that went into it.

2

It looks at the picture

A vision model compares the finished adaptation to its sources and decides which of them actually made it into the frame.

3

It corrects the rights

When a source was cropped out, the agent removes its rights from the asset and records exactly why.

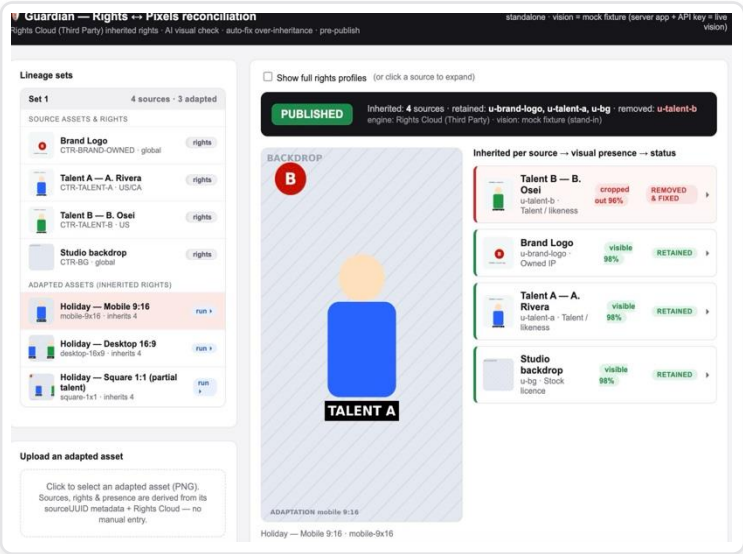
4

It escalates only when unsure

If it cannot tell whether a source is really there, it sends that single case to a person — and nothing else.

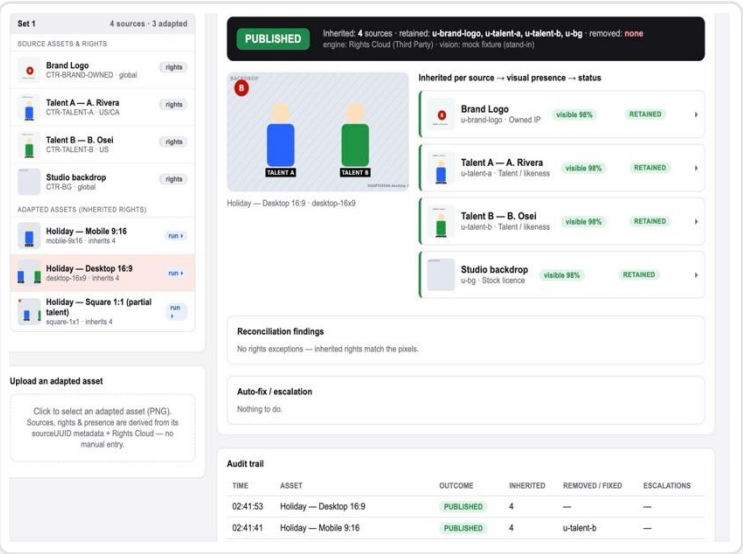
WHAT IT DECIDES

Most clear on their own. Only the doubtful reach a person.



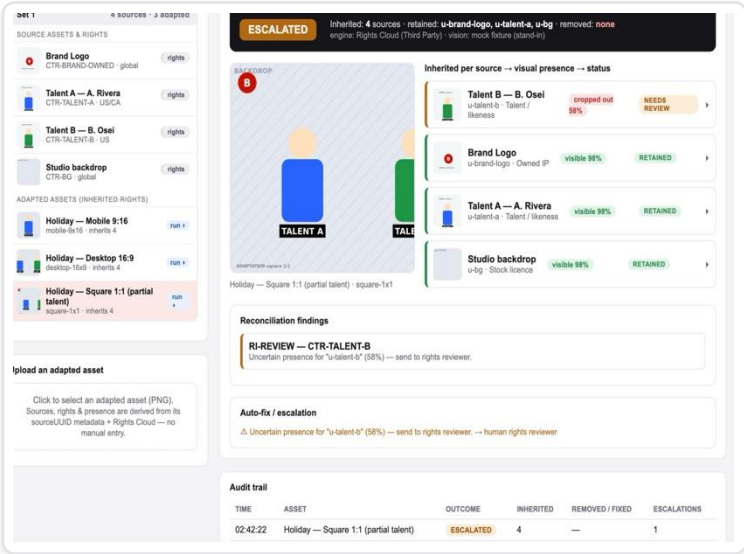
Auto-corrected

A cropped-out talent's rights are removed, and the asset publishes.



Cleanly published

Everything the rights claim is actually in the picture — nothing to do.



Sent to a person

At lower confidence, the agent holds the asset and asks a reviewer.

Every decision is written to an audit trail, so brand and legal can see what was checked, what changed, and why.

It already runs as an agent, called from an assistant

List adaptations

claude

yes for u-adp-mobile

I'll validate the rights for the mobile adaptation.

Used 2 tools ▾

Loaded tools >

Used guardian: Validate adapted asset rights >

Outcome: ✔ **PUBLISHED** — the mobile 9:16 adaptation passed the pre-publish rights gate, with one auto-remediation applied.

Run: run-1789848830270-89 (checkpoint: pre-publish)

What happened

Rights Cloud inherited rights from all 4 source assets, but the visual reconciliation found **Talent B is not present** in the cropped 9:16 frame. Its over-inherited rights were auto-removed.

Source	Present?	Confidence	Result
Brand Logo (Owned IP)	✔	98%	Retained
Talent A — A. Rivera	✔	98%	Retained
Talent B — B. Osei	✘	96% absent	Removed
Studio backdrop (Stock)	✔	98%	Retained

Key finding (auto-fixed)

- RI-OVER (high):** Rights inherited from u-talent-b (CTR-TALENT-B) but not visually present → over-scoped, removed. Corrected rights written back to AEM/Rights Cloud.

Worth noting

The removal is fortunate here — Talent B's contract carries a "no social media use" restriction and expires 2026-12-31, so keeping it on a mobile/social asset would have been compliance risk anyway. The retained assets all clear for keep auto-remediation on

+ 🔍 ▾ Accept edits

Opus 4.8 High 🔁

Not a mock-up

Here, an assistant (standing in for the AEM AI Assistant) asks the agent to check a real mobile adaptation. The rights system had inherited all four sources. The agent looked at the picture, found that Talent B had been cropped out with high confidence, removed her rights, and let the asset publish — the whole loop, with no one in the middle.

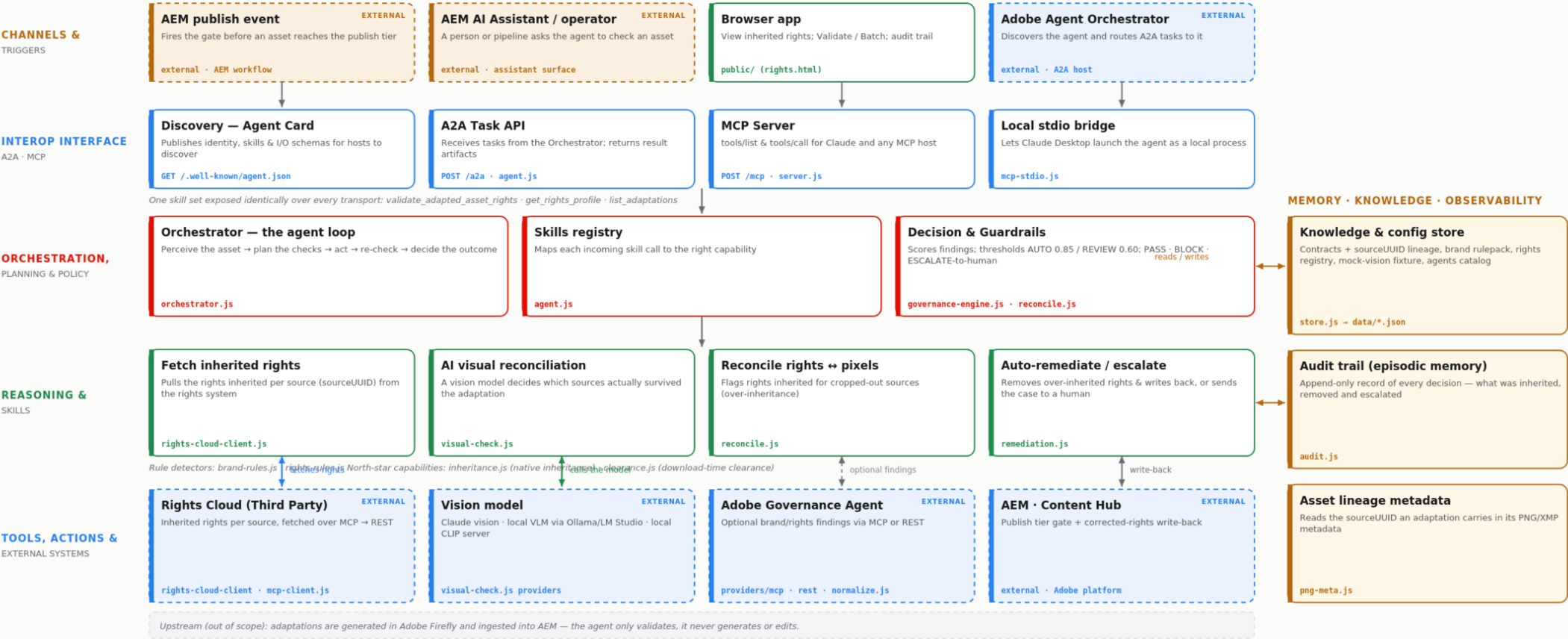
The same agent is reachable by the Adobe Agent Orchestrator over the standard agent protocols.

Agent Architecture

INTERNAL ARCHITECTURE · AGENTIC REFERENCE STACK

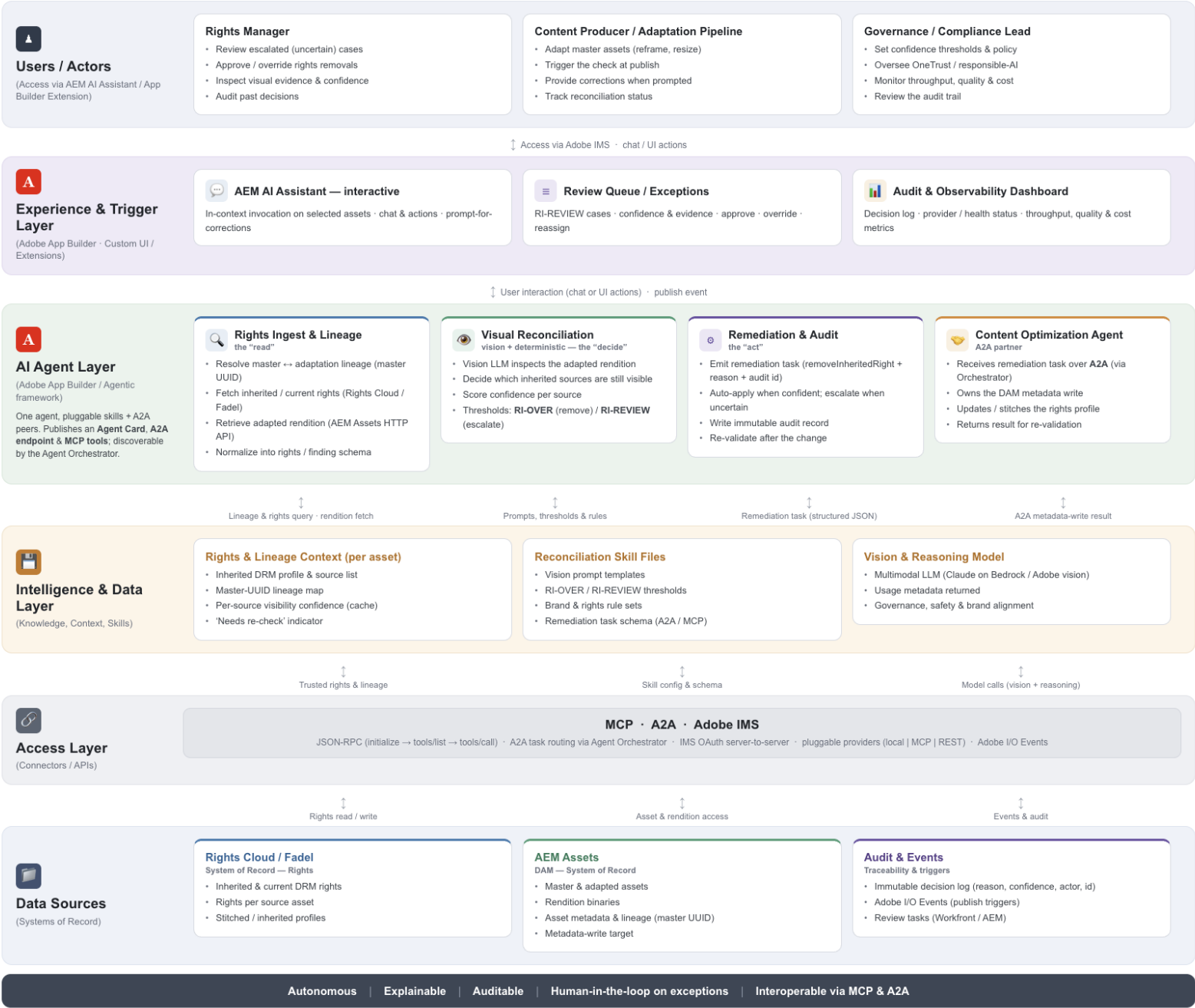
Rights Reconciliation Agent

Every component named by what it does and what it integrates with — internal modules, external systems, triggers, and memory.



Rights Reconciliation Agent (RRA · “Guardian”) – End-to-End Architecture

Autonomous, publish-time rights reconciliation built on Adobe App Builder, integrated with AEM Assets and enterprise rights systems (Rights Cloud / Fadel)



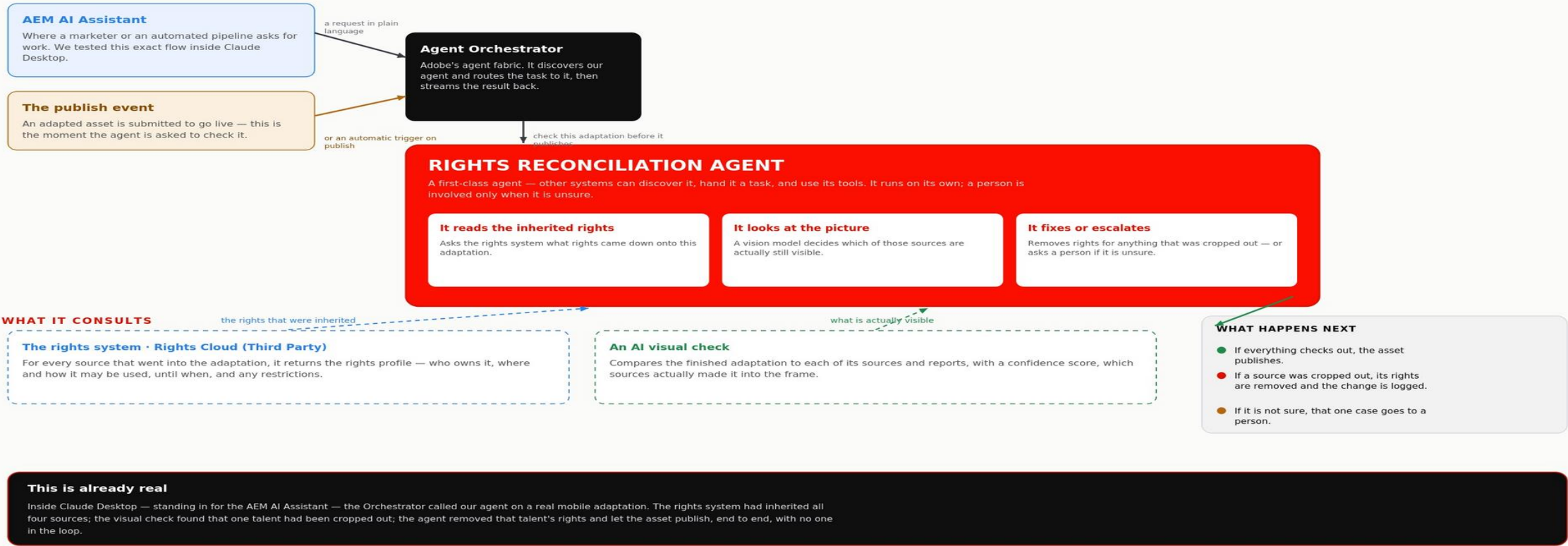
HOW IT RUNS TODAY

MVP — invoked at publish, via the Agent Orchestrator

MVP · HOW IT RUNS TODAY

The Rights Reconciliation Agent, invoked at publish

A person or a pipeline works in the AEM AI Assistant. When an adapted asset is about to publish, the Agent Orchestrator hands the job to our agent, which checks the rights against the picture and fixes or escalates on its own. Proven live inside Claude Desktop.



WHERE THIS GOES

North-star — one agent, across the whole rights lifecycle

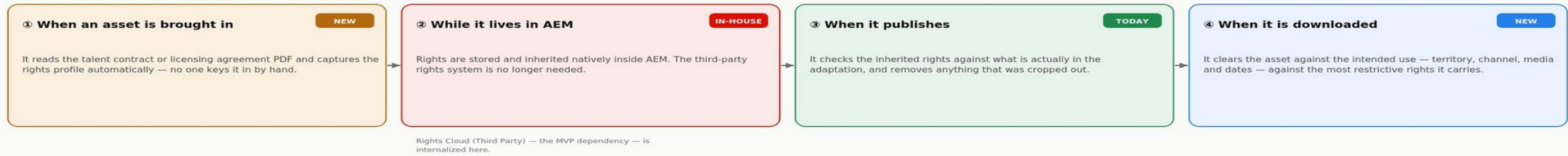
NORTH-STAR · WHERE THIS GOES

One agent that owns rights across the whole asset lifecycle

It fits the Adobe Agentic framework as a discoverable agent the Orchestrator can call. Over time it captures rights when an asset is first brought in, keeps and inherits them inside AEM, checks them at publish, and clears them again at download — so rights are never out of step with the work.



WHAT THE AGENT OWNS ACROSS THE LIFECYCLE



Why this fits Adobe's agentic vision

The Rights Reconciliation Agent registers like any other Adobe agent and is invoked by the Agent Orchestrator. It works on its own and only involves a person when it genuinely cannot tell. In its full form it becomes the single place rights are captured, kept, inherited, checked and cleared — so every AI-generated asset stays honest to what is actually in it, at any scale.

Owning rights from the first day to the last

1. Capture rights when an asset arrives

When a new source is brought in, the agent reads its talent contract or licensing agreement and records the rights automatically, so no one has to type them in.

2. Keep and inherit rights inside AEM

Rights live natively in AEM and flow to every adaptation from there — the external rights system is no longer a dependency.

3. Check the rights at publish

The reconciliation we run today: make sure an adaptation only claims the rights it can actually be seen to use.

4. Clear the rights at download

Before an asset is taken for a specific use, confirm that use is allowed under the most restrictive rights it carries.

What changes when the agent does this

Nearly all

adaptations clear with no human
touch

Close to zero

assets publish claiming rights they
don't show

Every asset

carries a plain record of what was
checked

Compliance at scale

Human in the loop where required,
not everywhere.

The rights team stops reviewing every adaptation and starts reviewing only the handful the agent genuinely cannot decide — while a full audit trail keeps brand and legal comfortable. Figures are illustrative targets for the pilot.

WHY IT WINS

A strong fit for the Incubator theme



It is genuinely different

It does not re-check an asset's own brand and rights the way existing agents do. It checks whether the rights match the actual pixels of a derivative — a gap nothing else fills.



It is ready and real

It already runs as an agent and demonstrated live end to end, not sketched on a slide.



It removes a true bottleneck

It replaces expert visual review that simply cannot scale to the volume of AI adaptations. A real-world customer use case.



It belongs in the ecosystem

It plugs into the Adobe Agentic framework as a discoverable agent the Orchestrator can call, today and at north-star.



Strong Northstar vision

Product capabilities can expand to auto rights capture from a given contract PDF



Rights Cloud Product Opportunity

Strong product roadmap possible with in house capabilities such as rights inheritance and clearance. A must have in AI era.

● *From learning to impact.*

Rights that always match what's actually in the picture.

Rights Reconciliation Agent · a registerable agent for the Adobe Agentic framework, running live today.

#acs-ai-hackathon-2026 · Team – The Guardians